

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Boil-water advisory

UTILITIES / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Use bottled water or bring clear tap water to a rolling boil for 1 minute, then cool it; above 6,500 feet, boil for 3 minutes. Use approved water for drinking, cooking and brushing teeth. Follow the exact local notice. Boiling does not remove chemical contamination.

Do now.

☐**Confirm the notice**

01

Check that it is a boil-water advisory, rather than do-not-drink or do-not-use.

☐**Boil and cool**

02

Use the local authority instructions; allow water to cool safely before use.

☐**Prevent accidental use**

03

Avoid connected refrigerator water and ice; use safe water for food, formula and pets.

☐**Follow the all-clear**

04

Resume normal use only after official clearance and any flushing instructions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If fuel or electricity is unavailable, use sealed drinking water first. A treatment tablet is an option only for microbial risk and only when its label covers the conditions. If you cannot establish whether chemicals are involved, change the water source rather than experimenting.

Watch for.

A household pitcher filter does not replace boiling during this advisory.

People & practical needs.

Keep one clearly marked clean-water supply for drinking, brushing teeth, food and medicine. Ask the care team about medical devices requiring special water

Next decision.

Keep bottled water and a safe means of boiling available. If boiling is impractical, use the alternative named by officials.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Boil-water advisory · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/boil-water-advisory/>